「Continuous.

Let $f: X \to Y$ be a map where X, Y are Metric spaces, and $a \in X$. TFAE:

a) f is continuous at a

b) If a sequence $\{x_n\} \subseteq X$ converges to a, then $\{f(x_n)\}$ converges to $f(a)$.

Proof. Suppose f is continuous at a. Let $\varepsilon > 0$ be given. Then, there exists $\delta > 0$ s.t

$$x \in B_\delta(a) \Rightarrow f(x) \in B_\varepsilon(f(a))$$

by definition. Put $N \in \mathbb{N}$ s.t

$$n \geq N \Rightarrow x_n \in B_\delta(a)$$

Now, for $n \geq N$,

$$f(x_n) \in B_\varepsilon(f(a))$$

To show the converse, using contraposition. Suppose that f is not continuous at a. That is, there exists $\varepsilon > 0$ s.t for any $\delta > 0$, there is $x \in B_\delta(a)$ satisfying

$$d(f(x), f(a)) \geq \varepsilon.$$

Therefore, for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, we can choose $x_n \in B_{\frac{1}{n}}(a)$ and $d(f(x_n), f(a)) \geq \varepsilon$. By construction, $\{x_n\}$ converges to a but $f(x_n)$ does not converges to $f(a)$.

「Thomae's function.

Define a map

$$T: (0, \infty) \to \mathbb{R}: x \mapsto \begin{cases} \frac{1}{p} & x = \frac{q}{p}, \text{ irreducible form (or } \gcd(p,q) = 1) \\ 0 & x \notin \mathbb{Q} \end{cases}$$

Then T is continuous at every irrational number, but not continuous at rationals.

Proof. Let $c \in (0, \infty)$ be an irrational number. Given $\varepsilon > 0$, there is $N \in \mathbb{N}$ s.t $\frac{1}{N} < \varepsilon$. Since there exist only finite number rationals such that the denominator smaller than N, more specifically, $S = \left\{1, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{2}{3}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{2}{4}, \frac{3}{4}, \dots, \frac{N-1}{N}\right\}$ (at most $\sum_{i=1}^{N-1} \sum_{j=1}^{i} 1$)

we can choose small enough $\delta > 0$ s.t $(c-\delta, c+\delta) \cap S = \emptyset$. Now,

$$|x - c| < \delta \Rightarrow |f(x) - f(c)| < \frac{1}{n} < \varepsilon$$

Therefore, f is continuous at irrationals. But, let $x \in (0, \infty)$ be a rational. Denote $x = \frac{q}{p}$ where $p, q \in \mathbb{N}$, $\gcd(p,q) = 1$. Taking $\varepsilon = \frac{1}{p}$. Then the density of irrationals gives

$$\forall \delta > 0, \quad \exists \text{ irrational } t \in (x - \delta, x + \delta) \text{ s.t } |f(x) - f(t)| = \frac{1}{p}$$

Thus, not continuous at irrationals.

「Exercise.

20.E Define a map

$$f:\mathbb{R}\to\mathbb{R} : x\mapsto \begin{cases} x & \text{if } x\notin\mathbb{Q} \\ 1-x & \text{if } x\in\mathbb{Q} \end{cases}$$

Then f is continuous only at $x=\frac{1}{2}$.

Sol). Let $\varepsilon>0$ be given. Taking $\delta=\varepsilon$. Then for any $x\in(\frac{1}{2}-\delta,\frac{1}{2}+\delta)$,

$$\left|f(x)-\frac{1}{2}\right| = \begin{cases} \left|x-\frac{1}{2}\right| & \text{if } x\notin\mathbb{Q} \\ \left|1-x-\frac{1}{2}\right| & \text{if } x\in\mathbb{Q} \end{cases}$$

Both case satisfies $\left|f(x)-\frac{1}{2}\right|<\varepsilon$. Therefore continuous.

Let $x\in\mathbb{R}$ with $x\neq\frac{1}{2}$. If $x\in\mathbb{Q}$, then by density of rationals, we can construct $\{x_n\}$ in $\mathbb{R}\setminus\mathbb{Q}$ s.t. $x_n\to x$ as $n\to\infty$

But $f(x_n)=x_n\to x$ as $n\to\infty$, not converges to $f(x)=1-x$.

Similarly, if $x\notin\mathbb{Q}$, it can be shown by the same process.

20.F If a continuous map $f:\mathbb{R}\to\mathbb{R}$ satisfies

$$f(x)=0 \quad \text{for all } x\in\mathbb{Q}$$

Then f is zero map.

Proof. Suppose that f is not zero map. Given $x\in\mathbb{R}$ satisfying $f(x)\neq 0$, take $\varepsilon=|f(x)|$.

For any $\delta>0$, by the density of rationals,

$$\exists t\in(x-\delta,x+\delta) \text{ s.t. } |f(x)-f(t)|=|f(x)|>\frac{1}{2}|f(x)|.$$

It is contradiction.

20.G Let $f,g:\mathbb{R}\to\mathbb{R}$ be continuous map. If $f(x)=g(x)$ $\forall x\in\mathbb{Q}$, then $f=g$.

Proof. Take $h=f-g$ and apply 20.F.